

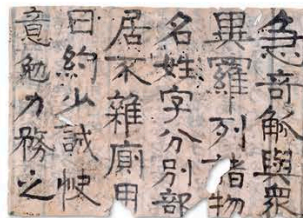


HAN INVENTIONS



MAGNETIC COMPASS

Many advances were made during the Han era. Inventions included the first magnetic compass, the wheelbarrow, and an early seismoscope (a device to detect earthquakes). Most important of all was the invention of paper by Cai Lun in 105 CE. The paper was made from tree bark, hemp, and linen.



PAPER

Shock waves trigger a ball to drop into the mouth of one of the frogs.



SEISMOSCOPE



WHEELBARROW

▲ THE SILK ROAD

The trade route known later as the Silk Road first opened up during the Han era, connecting China to Europe across Central Asia. Chinese merchants grew rich selling goods such as silk and ceramics, while gold and ivory were imported from the west. Ideas and technologies, such as that of papermaking, also spread along the route.



▲ BUDDHISM IN CHINA

Buddhism was introduced to China from India along the Silk Road, reaching the royal court in Luoyang by 65 CE. The first Buddhist temple, the White Horse Temple (above), was built in the city in 68 CE.